Samuel Liu

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Appointment

Post-doctoral Fellow August 2026–Current
Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica (IPSAS) *Taipei, Taiwan*

Pre-doctoral Fellow Jan 2026–May 2026
Institute for America, China, and the Future of Global Affairs (ACF), Johns Hopkins SAIS *Washington, D.C.*

Education

Cornell University 2026
Ph.D. Government *Ithaca, NY*

- Field: International Relations (major), Comparative Politics (minor)
- Dissertation: "Three Experiments on International Security in U.S.-China-Taiwan Relations"
- Committee: Jessica Chen Weiss (Chair), Sarah Kreps, Thomas Pepinsky

Cornell University 2023
M.A. Government *Ithaca, NY*

University College London 2019
MSc. Security Studies, Merit *London, UK*

University of Hong Kong 2018
BSocSc. Politics and Public Administration, First Class Hon. *Hong Kong*

Publications

1. Dafoe, Allan, Samuel Liu, Brian O'Keefe, and Jessica Chen Weiss. 2022. "Provocation, Public Opinion, and International Disputes: Evidence from China."*International Studies Quarterly* 66 (2): sqac006.
2. Zenobia T. Chan, Samuel Liu, and Kai Quek. 2021. "Audience Costs and the Credibility of Commitments." In *Oxford Bibliographies (International Relations)*. Oxford University Press.

Work in Progress

1. "Don't Try for a Second Mile: Credible Threats and Assurances in U.S.-China Coercion"
2. "Repairing Interconnected Credibility in Security Commitments: Evidence from Taiwan"
3. "Deterrence by Assurance? Domestic Costs of Counter-Coercion Strategies in Taiwan"
4. "Tactical Shift and Violence Perception" (with Polly Chan)

Teaching

Course Instructor

GOVT1101 Politics of Dissent in Hong Kong (Writing seminar).
Syllabus available upon request. Fall 2022

Teaching Assistant

GOVT3837 The Cold War (Writing seminar with Matthew Evangelista) Spring 2023
GOVT2897 Human Rights At War (Writing seminar with Matthew Evangelista) Spring 2022
GOVT3121 Crime and Punishment (with Joseph Margulies) Fall 2021
GOVT3443 Southeast Asian Politics (with Thomas Pepinsky) Spring 2021
GOVT3557 Exceptionalism Questioned: America and Europe
(Writing seminar with Peter Katzenstein) Fall 2020

Research Assistant

to Jessica Chen Weiss 2020–2021
Cornell University
to Kai Quek 2017–18
University of Hong Kong

Fellowships, Awards, and Grants

External

Replication + Novel Survey Experiment Competition, Northwestern University
(1,500 survey respondents and coauthorship opportunity) May 2026
Expense Support, Institute for Humane Studies ($1,500) 2026
World Politics and Statecraft Fellowship, Smith Richardson Foundation 2024–2026
($10,000 in 2025–26; $7,500 in 2024–25)
Doctoral Fellowship, Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation (one-year fellowship) 2024–25
China-U.S. Scholars Program Conference Grant, Institute of International Education ($4,000) 2024
U.S. Foreign Policy Dissertation Grant, Stand Together Trust ($5,000) 2023

Internal
(Only competitive awards listed)

Lee Teng-hui Fellowship, East Asia Program 2025–26
Research Travel Grant, Graduate School ($1,600) 2025
Lee Teng-hui Fellowship, East Asia Program (*declined*) 2024–25
Andrew Kohut Fellowship, Roper Center for Public Opinion Research Summer 2024
Small Research Grant, Qualitative & Interpretive Research Institute ($1,150) 2023

Presentations and Talks

Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science: 2026.
International Security and Public Opinion Workshop, Academia Sinica: 2025.
Empirical Studies on Conflict (ESOC): 2025.
American Political Science Association (APSA): 2019, 2024, 2025, 2026.
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2018, 2024, 2025
International Studies Association (ISA): 2026.
Lecture Series at Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica: 2025 March, October.

Service

Reviewer: *International Studies Quarterly*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *Journal of East Asian Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *International Interactions*, *British Journal of Politics and International Relations*, *Foreign Policy Analysis*

Skills

Languages: Cantonese (native) and Mandarin (fluent)
Software: R, Stata, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Git/Github
Fieldwork: Taiwan (2023–24)